

Jim Gillespie

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SUMMARY

Experienced technical communicator specializing in documenting complex software, hardware, and SaaS products. My goal is to improve usability, support customer success, and enable product adoption. My experience includes major contributions at IBM, AMD, HP TippingPoint, and National Instruments, where I improved documentation workflows, introduced reusable content strategies, and collaborated with cross-functional teams to enhance user experience and product quality. Consistently recognized throughout my career for managing multiple projects in dynamic environments and delivering high-quality content under tight deadlines.

SKILLS

Content Development: Structured Authoring • Information Architecture • Editing • Docs-as-Code • Agile/Scrum • DITA • XML • Markdown • OpenAPI/Swagger • HTML/CSS

Tools & Platforms: Oxygen Author • XMetaL • FrameMaker • Adobe Experience Manager • Content Management Systems (CMS) • SharePoint • WordPress • Adobe Creative Suite (Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign, Acrobat Pro) • Lucidchart • Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Visio) • Confluence • Jira • Trello • VMware

Engineering: JavaScript • Python • Java • C++ • Visual Basic • Git • Perforce • SVN • Azure DevOps • Visual Studio

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Writer | Independent Consultant | Austin, TX | Jan 2024–Present

- Conducted peer code reviews, providing feedback on developer-facing documentation.
- Applied writing and editing expertise to improve resumes for a diverse range of job seekers.
- Completed targeted coursework in cloud architecture, API design, and generative AI to deepen domain knowledge and expand documentation capabilities.

Senior Technical Writer | National Instruments | Austin, TX | Feb 2014–Dec 2023

- Crafted documentation that led to fewer customer support calls and savings in product support costs.
- Documented beta releases that propelled customer sales and facilitated marketing of automotive test solutions.
- Updated hardware specifications and revamped the PXIe-4322 user manual, securing stakeholder approval and enabling \$1.5M in customer order fulfillment.
- Migrated product documentation and build components from Perforce to Git, integrating with a developer-focused toolchain including Jira, Confluence, and Microsoft Azure DevOps.
- Established a cross-team documentation review process optimized for software development, hardware calibration, and compliance reviewers across global locations.
- Led monthly cross-functional meetings with Metrology, Calibration, and Technical Communication departments to prioritize projects, resolve issues, and ensure alignment.

Information Developer | HP TippingPoint (Contract) | Austin, TX | Jan 2013–Feb 2014

- Documented HP TippingPoint's first Next-Generation Firewall system.
- Collaborated with HP's UX team to ensure efficient process flow and product usability.
- Championed UX and documentation concerns in product development team scrums.
- Mentored new writers, training them on processes, tools, and best practices.
- Led writers through training and certifications in HPE network security solutions.

Technical Writer | AMD (Contract) | Austin, TX | Nov 2011–Dec 2012

- Analyzed processor design and reference guides, organized content into book-level DITA maps, and coded XML for FrameMaker-to-DITA document conversions.
- Streamlined DITA conversion, authoring, and documentation production processes using a new toolchain and customized scripts.
- Trained a team of 10 writers on using Oxygen Author, DITA conditional processing, SVN, and Alfresco CMS to create, edit, and curate documentation.

Technical Writer | Reddwerks | Austin, TX | Nov 2010–Nov 2011

- Developed company style guide with logo, corporate color scheme, font and font size directives, and word usage to ensure consistency in internal and external communication and documentation.
- Redesigned RMA forms to simplify usability and streamline the returns process.
- Provided hands-on user training to 20 warehouse workers on the supply chain picking system and wearable computer software features.
- Developed training manuals and user documentation for warehouse order fulfillment system.

RELEVANT PRIOR EXPERIENCE

- Information Developer | IBM Global Services/Tivoli Software
- Technical Writer | Aptis Software
- Information Specialist | Office of the Attorney General, Child Support Division
- Information Specialist | Comptroller of Public Accounts, Fiscal Management Division

EDUCATION

M.A. in English | Texas A&M University | College Station, TX

B.S. in English | Ball State University | Muncie, IN